

ANALYSIS, 20 MAY 2026, V4, PREPARED FOR AMISHA

A goals-first IA for the whole Kustomer platform.

Goals and Performance become core platform destinations alongside Inbox. Lower-frequency items move to overflow navigation, while the AI workspace focuses on one job: simplifying AIC and AIR configuration around organizational goals.

01 Principles for the goals-first IA

- 1 **Goals are platform primitives.** They live in the site rail, not inside AI. Reporting and Inbox reference them; they don't reference any of those.
- 2 **Outcome performance lives on the Goal; operational performance lives on the AI.** Each goal shows its own trajectory and at-risk state inline. AI's Analyze surface shows whether the AI itself is healthy and grades up into the goals it serves. Platform-level Performance is the cross-goal rollup, not a parallel source of truth.
- 3 **Setup, not configuration.** AIC and AIR each get a single, opinionated setup surface. Defaults are loud; advanced knobs are quiet.
- 4 **One wizard, two branches.** Get Started asks first whether the user is setting up AIC, AIR, or both, then runs the right sequence end to end.
- 5 **Goal context follows the user.** A conversation, a monitor alert, an agent suggestion, a report row all know which goals they touch and link back to the goal.
- 6 **Automations are first-class, and shared.** AI Setup creates a named automation by default. Admins add more from Manage Automations. Procedures, knowledge sources, tools, and guardrails in Building Blocks are reused across automations, edits propagate everywhere they're attached.

- 7

Per-automation settings stay where users expect them. Competitors lists, Secrets patterns, response Tone, greetings, verification, business hours, routing, and deployment conditions live on each automation's config page (mirroring production). Reusable guardrails (refund ceilings, escalation triggers, no-improvise rules) live in Building Blocks and attach to many automations.
- 8

Topics are org-level, not AI-level. The org's conversation taxonomy lives once under Reporting → Topics, auto-detected from history. Goals select a topic subset to declare scope; AI Setup, procedures, and reports all reference the same canonical taxonomy. Topic discovery never re-runs inside a wizard.
- 9

Goals facet by audience, not by surface. Every goal carries an audience tag (AIC, AIR, Sales, Human Reps, Other). The Goals destination filters by audience; AI Setup pre-filters to AI goals and auto-tags goals created from it. One canonical primitive, scoped views by default, all-org view on demand.
- 10

Advanced is preserved, not promoted. Build, Test, Deploy, Manage Automations carry a LEGACY pill under a "For power users" subheader and stop pretending to be parallel to setup.

02 Explore the proposed IA

Click any node to read its purpose, the rationale for placing it here, and a sketch of what its screen contains. The tree starts at the Kustomer platform level so the introduction of Goals and the elevation of Performance are visible at a glance.

KUSTOMER PLATFORM, IA TREE

Expand allCollapse

☺

Kustomer Platform

▼

🎯

Goals

NEW ▼

•

Create Goals (slide-out panel)

NEW

•

Goal detail

NEW

📈

Performance

NEW >

✦

AI

EXISTING >

-  Reporting

EXISTING >
-  Rep Dashboard

RENAMED
-  Inbox

EXISTING
-  Searches

EXISTING
-  TeamPulse

EXISTING
-  Global Search

EXISTING

Kustomer Platform > Goals

Goals

Cross-goal outcome rollup at the top, then the list. "Are we hitting what we said we'd hit?" Sparkline grid of every goal, at-risk lane, contribution-by-audience aggregate. Leadership view.



PURPOSE

The org's declared outcomes plus the leadership-level read on whether they're being hit. The header is a cross-goal outcome summary; the body is the audience-faceted goal list. Distinct from platform Performance, which is the cross-agent operational rollup.

 **GOALS REFERENCE**

This is where Goals are declared and tuned. Every other destination reads from this primitive, pre-filtered by audience when context is implied. The slide-out form is the

single canonical authoring surface for a goal regardless of where it opens from.

TOPICS REFERENCE

Goals select a topic subset to declare scope. Topic chips on each goal define what conversations it covers; coverage rollups read from the canonical Topics taxonomy.

SUGGESTIONS REFERENCE

AI Suggestions surface as ranked recommendations to fix what monitors and anomalies surface against each goal. Cross-goal queue lives at Performance, Suggestions.

OTHER TOUCHPOINTS

- **AI Setup**, provides scope (audience, topics, scenarios) for every new automation
- **AI for Customers / AI for Reps**, every attached automation drives one or more goals
- **Performance**, outcome trajectories roll up across all goals
- **Reporting → Data Explorer**, goals are a first-class dimension in ad-hoc queries
- **Performance, Suggestions**, suggestions targeting goals surface here

WHAT'S IN HERE

- **Outcome summary header** at the top of Goals Home: cross-goal sparkline grid, at-risk lane, contribution-by-audience aggregate (AIC / AIR / Human / Sales / Other), % on track / at risk / draft
- Links from any summary tile into platform Performance scoped to the contributing AI / human signals
- Goal list view with state, audience, owner, and progress
- Audience facet filtering and role-default scope
- State filters (Live, Limited, Testing, Attention, Draft)
- Time-window selection for trajectory readings
- Goal templates entry point
- Goal reports, per-goal trajectory, contribution breakdown by audience (AIC / AIR / Human / Sales / Other), period-over-period delta, topic-level slice, export, and schedule
- Cross-team goal authoring and management
- Audience faceting (AIC, AIR, Sales, Human Reps, Other)
- Goal templates and starter library
- Per-goal detail pages with outcome trajectory

- Goal pre-filtering by viewer role
- Pre-filtering contract for goal pickers opened from any destination

WHY IT LIVES HERE

Lifted out of the AI workspace and reframed as a platform primitive. The faceting model is the unlock that lets every team's goals coexist in one list without forcing AI admins to wade through sales-pipeline targets, or sales leaders through deflection percentages. Authoring stays a single canonical primitive (one slide-out); browsing adapts to context via persistent audience filters.

03 The full CX, end to end

One concrete journey for an AI admin setting up a new automation, from declaring the goal to tuning the live AI a month later. Every step lands on a destination that exists in the IA above; nothing is invented mid-flow.

1 Go to Goals PRIMARY NAV

Click Goals in the site rail. Goals Home opens pre-filtered to the viewer's role (AIC for this admin), with the 6 OOTB templates as a lead-in.



2 Create a new goal CREATE GOALS SLIDE-OUT

Click + **Create goal**. Fill in: "*Reduce refund tickets by 20%*", audience AIC (pre-filled), owner self, target *20% over 90 days*, **About your company** (pulled from account, editable), **Topics this goal covers** (multi-select from Reporting → Topics), and upload the org's **rep-training doc / SOP** as scenarios. Save.



3 Land on goal detail GOAL DETAIL

Topic chips and coverage stats appear at the top ("3 of 5 topics, 54% of 90d volume"). The parser surfaces draft procedures + suggested tools + knowledge from the uploaded doc, ready to attach. Empty attached-resources state below invites attaching an AI automation, monitor, or human workflow.



4 Attach AI automation GOAL DETAIL → AI SETUP

Click + **Attach AI automation**. Name it *Refund Order*. The wizard opens scoped to this goal and creates a new automation by default; the procedures, tools, and knowledge it produces land in Building Blocks and are reused by any other automation that needs them. (One goal can have many attached automations, and one automation can drive many goals.)

5

Wizard steps 1–3

AI → AI SETUP

Goal context strip at the top (read-only: company, topics, scenarios). The wizard captures only AI-specific knobs: *Where the AI shows up* (pre-set to AIC) → *Knowledge sources* → *Tone of voice*. Expected-deflectable shows as an info card based on the goal's topics ("AIC handles 75%, 25% routes to humans").

6

Review configuration

AI SETUP → REVIEW

Reviews what the parser already produced from the goal's scenario doc: **3 procedures, 2 knowledge sources, 4 tools**, all already in Building Blocks, tagged with the goal's topics. Computed Fields that feed this goal's threshold are linked from More → Settings. Edit inline or proceed.

7

Run tests

AI FOR CUSTOMERS → REFUND ORDER → TEST

Click **Run All Tests** on the Test tab inside the Refund Order automation. The AI runs against sample conversations grouped by category, Standard Refunds, Returns, Late Delivery, etc.

8

Analyze results

AI FOR CUSTOMERS → REFUND ORDER → ANALYZE

5 pass, 1 fails, *Damaged or Defective Items* at 23%. Three ways forward.

THREE WAYS FORWARD

Fix it now
Jump back to Topics or Knowledge, refine inputs, re-test. Same wizard, same state.

Deploy partial
Activate, but exclude the failing category. Smart-routing rule auto-generated to hand it off.

Override
Proceed with confirmation. Failing category flagged on the goal page so it isn't forgotten.

→ CONTINUE TO DEPLOY

9

Deploy & Activate

AI FOR CUSTOMERS → REFUND ORDER → DEPLOY

On the Deploy tab inside the Refund Order automation: set conditions (channel, body filters), confirm smart routing, click **Activate**.

10

Back to goal detail, AI live

GOAL DETAIL

Goal shows **Refund Order: Active**. Performance section transitions from empty to live; trajectory begins. Outcome performance lives here on the goal; operational signals on the AI itself live in AI → Analyze.

- 11

Two weeks later, tune

AI FOR CUSTOMERS → REFUND ORDER → ANALYZE

Goal shows **-14%**, on track. Click in. Use **Analyze** to see live operational signals, scorecards, drift alerts (anomalies from the Validation Agent), suggestion queue. Edit a procedure in Building Blocks, re-test, redeploy without leaving the goal.
- ▼
- 12

A month later, extend

GOAL DETAIL, MANAGE AUTOMATIONS

From the goal page attach a **performance monitor** (Quality Monitor scorecard) and a **human workflow** for edge cases. If the goal needs a second AI flow ("Damaged Items"), go to Manage Automations and add a new one (or use AI Setup), then attach it to the goal.

04 Risks the new Goals primitive introduces

Introducing Goals and Topics as platform-level primitives, splitting outcome performance (on Goals) from operational performance (on AI), and distributing Topics touchpoints across many destinations all create new surface-area tradeoffs. Severity reflects blast radius across personas.

#	RISK	SEVERITY	WHY IT HURTS
1	Site rail real estate	High	Goals + Performance compete with Inbox for rail attention. Overflow / kebab absorbs Apps, KB, Widgets, Settings, Help.
2	Cross-team primitive ownership	High	If Reporting, Inbox, AI, TeamPulse, and Sales each render Goals or Topics their own way, the primitives fragment. Beacon must own the schemas + component kit.
3	Goals + Topics are net-new concepts	Medium	Both primitives appear across many destinations on day one. Need a one-time intro flow plus migration that lifts existing per-automation goals into platform Goals.
4	Audience + topic tag drift	Medium	Mis-tagged goals or conversations fragment the pickers and rollups. Required-on-create, audit jobs, and auto-detect confidence flags mitigate.

#	RISK	SEVERITY	WHY IT HURTS
5	Goal reports moved to Goals Home	Medium	Users who land in Reporting may not realize Goal reports live on Goals. Cross-link callouts in Reporting and Data Explorer.
6	Audience boundary ambiguity	Medium	"Improve CSAT" plausibly belongs to AIC, AIR, and Human Reps at once. Multi-select audience + primary-owner field, plus a documented rubric.
7	Anomalies are AI-only by design	Low	Validation Agent only detects AI drift. Leaders may expect human-rep anomalies in the same place. Surface them via Monitors + Suggestions instead.
8	Computed Fields moved to Settings	Low	Power users used to finding fields in Building Blocks may miss the new home. Cross-link from every goal threshold config.
9	Performance naming	Low	Name may shift to "Observability" if research confusion lingers with the goal-page outcome trajectory.
10	AIC config surface scope creep	Low	The per-automation page could grow knobs back into a multi-tab spread. New toggles default to "advanced" until usage proves they earn promotion.

05 Friction points and fixes

Each remaining tension in the proposed IA, paired with the recommended resolution. Read across to find the highest-leverage fixes.

FRICITION	WHAT'S HAPPENING	SUGGESTION
Goal authoring entry points diverge	Goals can be created from Goals Home, AIC Build, AIC Settings, Manage Automations, an AIR config row, a Sales surface, or a goal pill in a conversation.	Lock the Create Goals slide-out as the only authoring component. Every entry point opens it with audience pre-filled from context.
"Mine" vs audience facets	"Mine" overlaps with audience facets; an AI admin's "Mine" is almost always their AI goals.	Pre-select the audience facet by viewer role on first visit; "Mine" filters within whatever facet is active.
Topics has two homes	Taxonomy management lives in Settings (rename, merge, hide). Analytical view lives in Reporting → Topics.	Cross-link both directions: "Manage taxonomy → Settings" from Reporting, "See analytics → Reporting" from Settings.
Computed Fields moved out of Building Blocks	Computed Fields now live in platform Settings. AI admins used to finding fields in the AI workspace may not discover them.	Cross-link from every goal threshold config to Settings → Computed Fields with the field selected.
AIC dropdown vs Manage Automations role split	Both surfaces show the AIC automation list. Risk that users bounce between them looking for the same controls.	Dropdown is switch-only (name + status + "→ Manage all" footer). Manage Automations owns add, edit, delete, duplicate, filter, sort, bulk.
Anomalies AI-only feels narrow	Anomalies live in AI Analyze + Performance rollup. Cross-agent leaders may expect human-rep anomalies in the same place.	Human degradation surfaces in Monitors (scorecard dips) and Suggestions (coaching paths). Add explanatory subhead on Performance.
Settings appears at platform level AND inside Advanced	Two destinations with similar names and different scopes.	Rename the Advanced child to "Settings (legacy)" with explicit sunset; limit platform Settings to org-wide concerns.
Tools not visible in primary nav	Shared Tools are the AI's hands; hiding them inside Building Blocks understates their operational weight.	Either surface Shared Tools at the same level as Connections inside AI, or expose top child destinations as a flyout on the Building Blocks row.

FRICTION	WHAT'S HAPPENING	SUGGESTION
No clear AI instance model	If a workspace has multiple AI instances, no chrome indicates which is currently selected.	Add an instance selector at the top of the AI workspace nav with the current instance shown by name.
First-run state reset visible	A demo affordance leaks into the production-feeling nav, eroding polish.	Hide it behind a tweak panel or debug menu; never ship it visible in production.

Prepared for Amisha · source vision: Goals-First Kustomer (May 2026, Aditya Subramaniam) · baseline: current Kustomer production navigation.